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MY JAVASCRIPT EXPERIENCE

At the start of the course, my level in programming didn't go beyond some html and css. I had done some python in high school but hated it and found it useless. The way I experienced programming there didn't appeal to me. In my head it was all about being stuck on a chair, meticulously looking at a screen to solve some mathematical problems. I was honestly a bit afraid before coming to this class. I had low expectations of what it would bring me and of my potential interest in it. I was partly wrong. I was 75% percent wrong to be more precise. I had no knowledge in Javascript, I just knew it by name, and I have been fascinated by all the possibilities you can do with this tool. Through the different projects such as the Art Jam, the Mod Jam, and especially the Variation Jam I experienced these possibilities and really enjoyed being able to create digital artworks like I did. I have gone to level 0 to being able to design a developed game!

This new activity that made me get out of my comfort zone, made me learn more about myself. I realized that I tend to create projects that are thoughtful or that have a certain depth. My Art Jam[1] was about time passing by and nostalgia. My Mod Jam[2] was about a story of a teenager playing the FrogFrogFrog game, we can see him on the instructions screen. When the game begins, you become that teenager and play the game. My Variation Jam[3] is about 3 regions, 3 atmospheres and 3 cultures. You run in 3 places with different roads, different elements and a different character while listening to different songs associated with the culture of that place. I don't know if my intentions are always understood, which is something I have realized thanks to the course, and that I can now work on even though I like the spectator or player to think and understand the ideas by himself.

The new skills that I gained thanks to this course can be incorporated into my creative practice. As a whole, in the course, I have learned how to draw in JavaScript. More precisely I learned how to use functions, variables, loops, arrays, and more. These skills helped me to create things such as abstract illustrations as well as figurative images in motion, or randomly generated texts. Potentially, as a digital artist, I could use the skills that I have learnt during the course in future assignments and projects. For graphic design for example, using JavaScript

could open new possibilities, beyond software like Adobe Illustrator or Photoshop. I could also use JavaScript to make simple animated characters as well as interactive elements on websites, as I am comfortable with designing characters and getting ideas that I can then translate into codes. I could also go beyond the course to work on my weaknesses and begin big projects, maybe doing the same prompts again but in very more developed versions. This would help me reinforce my understanding of JavaScript's logical reasoning. Moreover, something that I would really work on is interactivity. Firstly, because my understanding of this topic is nearly inexistent. My level of knowledge in this area stops now at functions 'MousePressed' and 'KeyPressed', and I feel like there is a lot more to see and experiment with. Secondly because I have been to lots of museums where digital interactivity was at the heart of the exhibitions and these experiences are still in my memories as well as in my tier list of my best times in museums. After developing these skills, I could set myself ambitious goals and ultimately my games would entertain people, and I could be recognized for them.

However, this is not the way I want it to be. I have liked the process of creating games but in my mind, I want it to stay a hobby, a skill that I don't necessarily want to develop. Although my understanding of creative coding changed, I was right on one point at the very beginning. My interest in coding is not in the coding itself, but simply in imagining the ideas, and creating digital works with them. Getting the ideas is the part I am interested in. But then, to code them, that's when it becomes hard. I like it when it's hard, but I need to find an interest behind what is hard, a goal, a purpose.

At the beginning of the course, it was fun to see the possibilities you can do but over time it quickly became overwhelming. Beginning with the Mod Jam challenge I realized the massive amount of knowledge you must have regarding JavaScript to make a game or complex work by yourself, without using AI. The logical reasoning of this language, the meticulous work each task takes, kind of made me crazy at some point during the assignments. Debugging, for example, was funny at first, you search for the mistakes and solve problems as a detective would solve a murder. But it quickly becomes tiresome. I feel like while I couldn't live without having ideas and creating, I could live without coding. Still, I could use AI and pursue on this path, giving it my ideas and it would code them for me, but I don't think that it is the spirit of programming itself, it would be like playing piano but only with two notes, stagnating , creating but not knowing how it works, just 'working' thanks to a computer and not on the computer. If I was to do that, I would very probably feel dehumanized and useless. There wouldn't be any challenge, or any purpose at all, it would become trivial.

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However, I think that in the future, I could use Javascipt to elaborate on diverse interdisciplinary projects. I want to be a video maker, and as a digital artist I believe that there is space for everything to experiment with. I could possibly develop a game and post it in my bio some day or even create simple and funny games, or interactive illustrations. No matter what I do I think that that knowledge I gained in this course strengthened my logical reasoning and taught me something new about digital arts I didn't expect would interest me so much.

1. My ART JAM

2. My MOD JAM

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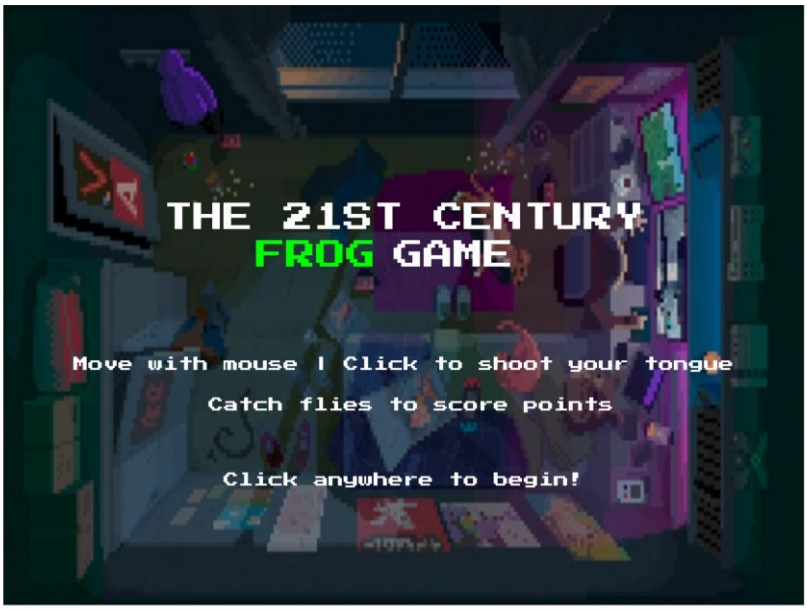

3. My VARIATION JAM